

AI Chatbots vs AI Agents

Differences Between AI Chatbots and AI Agents

AI Chatbots:

- Purpose: Conversational interaction, answering questions.
- Scope: Limited to specific domains (e.g., support, FAQ).
- Memory: Usually stateless or short term.
- Autonomy: Reactive, waits for user input.
- Integration: Embedded in messaging platforms or websites.
- Complexity: Simpler models for NLU/NLG.

AI Agents:

- Purpose: Autonomous actions, decision making, goal achievement.
- Scope: Multi domain, can orchestrate tools and workflows.
- Memory: Long term state and context.
- Autonomy: Proactive, can initiate actions.
- Integration: Works with APIs and external services.
- Complexity: Includes planning, reasoning, tool use.

Key Takeaways:

- Chatbots are conversational partners; agents are autonomous executors.
- Agents combine language understanding with tool use and decision making.
- Use chatbots for support/FAQ; use agents for automation and complex tasks.

This document outlines core distinctions to help choose the right technology.